

from a licensed attorney and not from court staff. Plaintiffs may bring this motion pursuant to the Court's pre-trial orders when Motions in Limine are requested by the Court.

No appearance is required at the hearing on June 3, 2026.

12. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00261
CASE NAME: KIKI BROWS VS. RAMANUJAN GROUP LLC
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: BE RELIEVED AS COUNSEL**

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Summary

Defendant Ramanujan Group LLC's ("Defendant") counsel, Kutak Rock LLP, and Brian J. Wagner, Esq.'s ("Withdrawing Counsel") filed a Motion to Be Relieved as Counsel for Defendant ("Motion") on February 3, 2026. The Motion is **granted** as set forth herein. No appearance is required on June 3, 2026.

Background

Plaintiff Kiki Brows alleges a breach of contract, fraud and reliance causes of action by Defendant related to a lease of business premises located at 3570 Blackhawk Plaza Cir., C-04A, Danville, California. Withdrawing Counsel filed a Motion to Be Relieved as Counsel for Defendant, supported by his declaration claiming that irreconcilable differences and a breakdown of attorney client relationship has occurred. Withdrawing Counsel can no longer represent Defendant.

Analysis

Cal. Rules of Court Rule No. 3.1362 and Cal. Code of Civ. Proc. §§284(1) and (2) sets forth the standard and procedure to be relieved as counsel of record. The Code permits an attorney to be changed at any time before or after judgment or final determination "upon the consent of both client and attorney," or "upon order of the court, upon the application of either client or attorney, after notice from one to the other." Defendant's Counsel has complied with the provisions of this rule and statute providing notice to Plaintiff and supporting this motion with a declaration articulating the reasons for withdrawal.

The Court finds that there is good cause to grant this Motion to relieve Withdrawing Counsel. The Court acknowledges that the prejudice to Defendant is minimal, as there is ample time for Defendant to retain trial counsel. No trial date has been set and no dispositive motions are currently on calendar.

Ruling

After reviewing the papers and arguments submitted by counsel and after considering and weighing the prejudice to both sides, and reviewing the relevant statutory and decisional authority, the Court finds that there is good cause to grant the Motion of Withdrawing Counsel to be Relieved as Counsel of Record. The makes the following orders:

1. This motion is **granted**.
2. The Court will execute the Proposed Order Granting Attorney's Motion to be Relieved as Counsel (Judicial Council Form MC-053) as submitted on February 3, 2026. The withdrawal is effective immediately.
3. Defendant's Counsel is ordered to serve a copy of the Order (MC-053) to Plaintiff by mail at his last known address, along with a change of address form, Judicial Council Form MC-040, instructing the client to fill-out and file the change of address form with the Court.
4. The Court schedules a Case Management Conference for December 1, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. Withdrawing Counsel is ordered to provide notice to Plaintiff of this CMC, and to inform Plaintiff that he/they are ordered to appear.
5. Withdrawing counsel shall file a proof of service form indicating that the client was served with the Court's Order (MC-053) and the Change of Address form (MC-040).
6. No appearance is required on June 3, 2026.

13. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00387

CASE NAME: MAYKELIN REYES VS. M & M BAKERY PRODUCTS, INC.

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: PRELIMINARY APPROVAL OF CLASS ACTION AND PAGA SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT AND CLASS NOTICE**

FILED BY: REYES, MAYKELIN MENDOZA

TENTATIVE RULING:

Summary

Plaintiff Maykelin M. Reyes' Motion for Preliminary Approval of Settlement is **granted** as set forth herein. No appearance is required on June 3, 2026.

Background and Settlement Terms

This case involves a wage-and-hour class action lawsuit filed by Plaintiff Maykelin Mendoza Reyes ("Plaintiff") against Defendant M & M Bakery Products, Inc. ("Defendant") The Plaintiff is seeking preliminary approval of a proposed \$365,000 settlement to resolve claims related to alleged violations of California labor laws, including the California Private Attorneys General Act of 2004 (PAGA). The settlement was reached after extensive investigation, informal discovery, and arm's-length negotiations between the parties, which were facilitated through mediation by experienced neutral mediator Deborah Crandall Saxe, Esq.

The proposed settlement would provide monetary payments to approximately 236 Class Members who collectively worked an estimated total of 16,000 workweeks during the Class Period (February 7, 2021, to August 21, 2025). Additionally, 115 Aggrieved Employees under PAGA who worked an estimated total of 3,556 pay periods during the PAGA Period (January 19, 2024, to August 21, 2025) would receive payments. The settlement is structured as non-reversionary, meaning that under no circumstances will any of the funds be reverted to the Defendant.

The \$365,000 gross settlement amount is all-inclusive and excludes Defendant's employer taxes, which will be paid separately. From this amount, \$10,000 is allocated for PAGA penalties (35% to Aggrieved Employees and 65% to the Labor and Workforce Development Agency). The remaining Net Settlement Amount will be distributed after deducting payments for the Class Representative Service